- TSDBs, such as Prometheus, are a great choice for the metrics signal type (numerical aggregates), until you run into cardinality explosion.
- Use columnar data stores and formats for high-cardinality signals and use cases.
- Make sure you have a good idea of what exactly you want to store (e.g., logs versus metrics).
- Due to data gravity, careful selection of your backends is crucial (to avoid large export–import costs when transferring data).
- Be aware of the direct and indirect costs in the ingestion, storage, and query phases when selecting a backend.
- Choose support for open standards concerning query languages and wire formats in backends over proprietary ones to minimize lock-in and maximize interoperability.